

Crownfall: Sovereign's Hand — Paper Prototype Rules

Rules version 0.2-paper-1 · 2 players · about 15–20 minutes · not for sale

THE GOAL

Break all five of your rival's Crown Shards.

Deploy champions, Ascend them from ★ to ★★★, and attack your rival's Crown. A champion that attacks can't guard your Crown on your rival's turn, so every attack leaves you open.

WHAT YOU NEED

- One starter deck each: 30 cards, plus 8 Ascension cards (★★ and ★★★ forms).
- A Command counter each (the Command track on the token sheet with a coin, or a ten-sided die).
- Shield tokens and a few coins to mark "this turn" changes.
- Opaque card sleeves are recommended, so face-down cards stay hidden.

YOUR PLAY AREA

Zone	What goes there
Deck	Your face-down 30-card deck.
Crown	Your 5 Crown Shards: face-down cards from your own deck.
Ascension Pile	Your 8 ★★/★★★ cards, face-down. You never draw from it.
Champion Zones (4)	Your champions in play.
Scheme Zones (3)	Your face-down Schemes.
Fallen pile	Defeated champions (with their whole stack) and used Tactics and Schemes, face-up.

SETUP

1. Shuffle your deck. Put the top 5 cards face-down in your Crown, without looking. These are your **Crown Shards**.
2. Flip a coin. The winner goes first.
3. The first player draws 5 cards. The second player draws 6.

4. Once each, you may shuffle your hand back and draw the same number again.
5. The first player skips their draw on their first turn. The second player gets +1 **Command** on their first turn.

YOUR TURN

1. Rise

Stand all your sideways cards back up (**ready** them). Raise your Command dial by 1, to a maximum of 8, and refill your Command to that number.

From round 10: "The Crown grows impatient." Break one of your own shards before you do anything else.

2. Draw

Draw 1 card. If your deck is empty, break one of your own shards instead.

3. Main

Do any of these in any order, as long as you can pay:

- **Deploy** a ★ champion: pay its cost and put it in an empty Champion Zone. It can block straight away, but it can't attack this turn unless it has **Charge**.
- **Cast a Tactic**: pay its cost, do what it says, then put it in your Fallen pile.
- **Set a Scheme**: put it face-down in a Scheme Zone for free. You can't spring it during the turn you set it.
- **Ascend**, once per turn (see below).

4. Battle

Attack with your champions, one at a time (see Combat).

5. After battle

If you haven't Ascended this turn, you may Ascend now.

6. End

All "this turn" changes end. Discard down to 8 cards. Command you didn't spend **stays on your dial**, and

you can use it on your rival's turn to spring Schemes and cast Swift Tactics.

ASCENDING (★ → ★★ → ★★★)

Your ★★ and ★★★ cards wait in your Ascension Pile, so you never need to draw them.

Once per turn, either during your Main step or after battle:

1. Choose a champion that was already on the field when your turn began, and whose next form is in your Ascension Pile.
2. Pay that form's **Ascend cost** (the ↑ number).
3. Place the new form on top of the champion. Its Shield stays.
4. **Turn the champion sideways.** Ascending uses up its action, so it can't attack or block until your next turn. A champion that already attacked is sideways anyway, so it can still Ascend.
5. Resolve its **Ascend:** text, if it has any.

The real choice: Ascend before battle to use the Ascend effect now, Ascend after battle with a champion that has already attacked, or keep the champion standing so it can guard your Crown.

COMBAT

1. **Attack.** Choose one of your ready champions that can attack. Choose a target: your rival's **Crown**, or **any rival champion**. Turn your attacker sideways and resolve its **Attack:** text.
2. **Block** (only if the Crown is attacked). Your rival may block with one of their ready champions, turning it sideways (a champion with **Bulwark** stays standing). A champion with **Flight** can only be blocked by Flight or Reach. Resolve the blocker's **Block:** text.
3. **Respond.** The defender may spring one Scheme or cast one Swift Tactic. Then the attacker may cast one Swift Tactic.
4. **Clash** (if there is a defender). Compare at the same time:
 - If the attacker's **Might** is equal to or greater than the defender's **Guard**, the defender is defeated.
 - If the defender's **Might** is equal to or greater than the attacker's **Guard**, the attacker is defeated.

- A champion with 0 Might defeats nothing.

5. Break shards.

- An unblocked Crown attack breaks **1** shard, or **2** if the attacker is ★★★ (shown by the 🗡️ 2 symbol on the card).
- **Breakthrough:** if the attacker defeats its blocker and survives, it still breaks 1 shard.

A defeated champion goes to its owner's Fallen pile with its whole stack. Shields on it are lost.

BREAKING A SHARD

Take the top shard into your **hand**. It was always one of your own cards. If it has **Shardfall**, you may cast it or set it immediately for free, even on your rival's turn.

You lose the moment your last shard breaks.

TERMS

Term	Meaning
Shield	Put a Shield token on the champion. The next time it would be defeated, remove the token instead. A champion holds at most 1 Shield.
Scorch X	The champion gets -X Guard this turn.
Mend 1	Put a card from your hand face-down into your Crown as a new shard (5 shards maximum).
Charge	Can attack the turn it is deployed.
Bulwark	Blocking doesn't turn this champion sideways.
Ambush	When this attacks a sideways champion, it strikes first. If the defender is defeated, it doesn't strike back.
Flight / Reach	Flight can only be blocked by champions with Flight or Reach.
Swift	This Tactic can also be cast in a response window, on either player's turn.
Ascendant	A Tier V champion. A deck may hold only one.
Arrival: / Ascend: / Attack: / Block:	Happens when the champion is deployed / Ascends into this form / attacks / blocks.
Round	Both players have taken one turn.

QUICK ANSWERS

- **Can I attack a champion instead of the Crown?** Yes, any rival champion, standing or

sideways. No shards break, but you can clear a blocker away.

- **Does damage stay on a champion?** No. Every clash is a fresh comparison.

- **Can a champion that just arrived block?**

Yes.

- **Who acts first in a response window?** The defender, then the attacker. Each side gets one response per attack.